

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 3

Chapter 13: वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः (Varna-Matra: Vowel Quantity)

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	13 — वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः (Varna-Matra: Vowel Quantity)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Classic traps: a दीर्घ vowel = 2 मात्रा (not 1) and प्लुत = 3 (Sanskrit has THREE quantities, not two); a मात्रा measures TIME, not weight or pitch; counting मात्रा means adding each vowel's value (ह्रस्व 1, दीर्घ 2, प्लुत 3) across a word, NOT counting letters or consonants; a syllable is गुरु (heavy) if its vowel is दीर्घ OR a ह्रस्व vowel is followed by a conjunct / अनुस्वार (ं) / विसर्ग (ः); रौति is SINGULAR and रुवन्ति PLURAL (a number difference, not tense); and वर्ण here means sound/letter, not caste. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. If one ह्रस्व (short) vowel is defined as taking exactly one मात्रा of time, then a दीर्घ vowel held for the SAME spoken duration as two short vowels takes how many मात्रा?

- (A) one मात्रा (B) three मात्रा
(C) two मात्रा (D) half a मात्रा

2. A teacher says: 'A मात्रा answers the question how-LONG, not how-HEAVY or how-HIGH.' Which property of a vowel does a मात्रा therefore measure?

- (A) its loudness (B) its pitch (musical note)
(C) its weight in grams (D) its duration in time

3. Why can a मात्रा be called a RELATIVE unit rather than a fixed clock-time like one second?

- (A) because it is defined as the time of a short vowel, so it speeds up or slows down with the speaker's pace
(B) because it is always exactly one second long

(C) because it is measured with a ruler in centimetres

(D) because it changes the caste of the word

4. A drumbeat marks one short vowel per beat. To pronounce a single दीर्घ vowel correctly, the reciter should hold it for:

(A) one beat

(B) two beats

(C) three beats

(D) half a beat

5. The root sense of मात्रा ('measure') best parallels which English word?

(A) 'colour'

(B) 'metre' / 'measurement'

(C) 'caste'

(D) 'silence'

6. A student lists vowel quantities as 'short and long only'. The single most important correction is to add:

(A) a fourth, even longer, quantity

(B) anusvāra as a fourth vowel-length

(C) two more pitches

(D) प्लुत (prolonged), the third quantity worth three मात्रा

7. Arrange ह्रस्व, दीर्घ, प्लुत by INCREASING मात्रा, then state the total मात्रा if you sound one of EACH once.

(A) प्लुत, दीर्घ, ह्रस्व; total = 6 मात्रा

(B) ह्रस्व, दीर्घ, प्लुत; total = 3 मात्रा

(C) दीर्घ, ह्रस्व, प्लुत; total = 5 मात्रा

(D) ह्रस्व, दीर्घ, प्लुत; total = 1 + 2 + 3 = 6 मात्रा

8. If a chanter sounds a प्लुत vowel and then a ह्रस्व vowel, the प्लुत is how many times as long as the ह्रस्व?

(A) twice as long

(B) three times as long

(C) the same length

(D) half as long

9. Which statement about the THREE quantities is internally consistent?

(A) दीर्घ is exactly twice ह्रस्व, and प्लुत is exactly three times ह्रस्व

(B) दीर्घ equals ह्रस्व, and प्लुत is twice ह्रस्व (C) प्लुत equals दीर्घ, and both are twice ह्रस्व

(D) ह्रस्व is the longest of the three

10. A reciter holds three vowels for 1, 2 and 3 मात्रा respectively. Their quantity-names, in that order, are:

(A) ह्रस्व, दीर्घ, प्लुत

(B) दीर्घ, ह्रस्व, प्लुत

(C) प्लुत, दीर्घ, ह्रस्व

(D) ह्रस्व, प्लुत, दीर्घ

11. The descriptive label अल्पकालिक: ('short-time') and अतिविलम्बकालिक: ('very-delayed-time') belong respectively to:

(A) दीर्घ and ह्रस्व

(B) ह्रस्व and प्लुत

(C) प्लुत and ह्रस्व

(D) ह्रस्व and दीर्घ

12. In the word रामः, the vowels are आ (in रा) and अ (in the म before ः). Classifying each vowel, we get:

- (A) both आ and अ are ह्रस्व (B) both आ and अ are दीर्घ
(C) आ is दीर्घ (2 मात्रा) and अ is ह्रस्व (1 मात्रा) (D) आ is प्लुत and अ is दीर्घ

13. Among अ, आ, इ, ई, उ, ऊ, exactly how many are ह्रस्व (short)?

- (A) two (B) four
(C) three (अ, इ, उ) (D) all six

14. The vowel ई (as in नदी) is best classified as:

- (A) ह्रस्व — 1 मात्रा (B) प्लुत — 3 मात्रा
(C) दीर्घ — 2 मात्रा (D) not a vowel at all

15. Which set contains ONLY दीर्घ vowels?

- (A) आ, ई, ऊ (B) अ, इ, उ
(C) अ, आ, इ (D) क, ख, ग

16. A reciter draws out the call 'भोऽ-3' for three मात्रा. This vowel is:

- (A) प्लुत (prolonged, 3 मात्रा) (B) ह्रस्व (1 मात्रा)
(C) दीर्घ (2 मात्रा) (D) a consonant

17. Count the total मात्रा in गजः, where the syllables carry the vowels अ (in ग) and अ (in ज before ः).

- (A) 3 मात्रा (B) 4 मात्रा
(C) 2 मात्रा (अ = 1, अ = 1) (D) 1 मात्रा

18. Count the total मात्रा in माला: the vowels are आ (in मा) and आ (in ला).

- (A) 2 मात्रा (B) 3 मात्रा
(C) 4 मात्रा (2 + 2) (D) 6 मात्रा

19. Count the total मात्रा in नदी: vowels अ (in न) and ई (in दी).

- (A) 2 मात्रा (B) 4 मात्रा
(C) 3 मात्रा (अ = 1, ई = 2) (D) 1 मात्रा

20. Count the total मात्रा in सीता: vowels ई (in सी) and आ (in ता).

- (A) 4 मात्रा (2 + 2) (B) 2 मात्रा
(C) 3 मात्रा (D) 5 मात्रा

21. Count the total मात्रा in कमलम्: vowels अ (in क), अ (in म), and अ (in ल before the final म्).

- (A) 3 मात्रा (1 + 1 + 1) (B) 4 मात्रा
(C) 6 मात्रा (D) 2 मात्रा

22. Count the total मात्रा in गीता: vowels ई (in गी) and आ (in ता).

- (A) 3 मात्रा (B) 4 मात्रा (2 + 2)
(C) 2 मात्रा (D) 5 मात्रा

23. Two words are recited: रवि (अ, इ) and रवी (अ, ई). By how many मात्रा is रवी longer than रवि?

(A) the same length

(B) 1 मात्रा longer (रवि = 2, रवी = 3)

(C) 2 मात्रा longer

(D) रवी is shorter

24. A pupil recites भू (a single long ऊ syllable) drawn out for three मात्रा by mistake. What has the pupil actually produced, and what was intended?

(A) produced a ह्रस्व where a दीर्घ was intended

(B) produced a दीर्घ where a प्लुत was intended

(C) produced a consonant where a vowel was intended

(D) produced a प्लुत (3 मात्रा) where a दीर्घ (2 मात्रा) was intended

25. A syllable is called गुरु (heavy) when its vowel is दीर्घ, OR when a short vowel is followed by a conjunct, अनुस्वार or विसर्ग. In the word सत्यम् the first syllable स carries a short अ followed by the conjunct त्य. The first syllable is therefore:

(A) लघु (light), because अ is a short vowel (B) गुरु, because अ is itself a long vowel

(C) लघु, because conjuncts never affect weight

(D) गुरु (heavy), because the short अ is closed by the following conjunct त्य

26. In राजा the first syllable र has the long vowel आ. By the weight rules, रा is:

(A) लघु (light), because it has only one consonant

(B) गुरु, because it is followed by a conjunct (C) गुरु (heavy), because its vowel आ is दीर्घ

(D) लघु, because आ is short

27. In अंशः the first syllable अं is short अ followed by अनुस्वार (ं). Its weight is:

(A) गुरु (heavy), because the अनुस्वार closes the short vowel

(B) लघु (light), because अ is short (C) गुरु, because अ is long

(D) neither — अनुस्वार removes the vowel

28. In दुःखम् the first syllable दुः is short उ followed by विसर्ग (ः). Its weight is:

(A) गुरु (heavy), because the विसर्ग closes the short vowel

(B) लघु (light), because उ is short (C) गुरु, because उ is long

(D) लघु, because विसर्ग is silent

29. In the word कमलम् the syllable क carries short अ followed by the single consonant म (one consonant, not a cluster). The syllable क is:

(A) लघु (light), because a short vowel followed by only a single consonant onset of the next syllable stays light

(B) गुरु, because any consonant after it makes it heavy

(C) गुरु, because अ is long

(D) neither light nor heavy

30. Classify the two syllables of गङ्गा: ग (short अ before the conjunct ङ्ग) and गा (long आ).

(A) both लघु

(B) first लघु, second गुरु

(C) both गुरु — the first by the following conjunct ङ्ग, the second by its long आ

(D) first गुरु, second लघु

31. Which single feature is enough, by itself, to make a syllable गुरु (heavy) even if its vowel is short?

- (A) the syllable beginning with a vowel
- (B) the syllable carrying a high musical pitch
- (C) the short vowel being followed by a conjunct, अनुस्वार or विसर्ग
- (D) the word being a noun

32. In शान्तिः the syllables are शा (long आ) and न्ति (short इ before विसर्ग) — actually शा (long आ), and the cluster gives न्तिः. Considering शा alone, its weight, and why, is:

- (A) लघु, because it is the first syllable
- (B) गुरु, only because of the following न्
- (C) लघु, because आ is a short vowel
- (D) गुरु, because its vowel आ is दीर्घ (long by nature)

33. A student says: 'Counting मात्रा is the same as counting letters.' The best correction is:

- (A) yes — every letter is exactly one मात्रा
- (B) no — you count only consonants
- (C) no — you add each VOWEL's मात्रा value (1, 2 or 3); consonants without vowels and the letters themselves are not counted
- (D) yes — but only long vowels count

34. By the vowel-sandhi rule, इ + इ combine to a single long ई (e.g. गिरि + ईशः → गिरीशः). In terms of मात्रा, two short vowels (1 + 1) become:

- (A) one ह्रस्व vowel of 1 मात्रा — half is lost
- (B) one दीर्घ vowel of 2 मात्रा — the total time is conserved
- (C) one प्लुत vowel of 3 मात्रा — time is added
- (D) two separate vowels still 1 मात्रा each

35. अ + आ → आ (e.g. हिम + आलयः → हिमालयः). The junction vowel changes from short अ (1 मात्रा) followed by long आ (2) into a single आ. The single आ is worth:

- (A) 3 मात्रा (it becomes प्लुत)
- (B) 2 मात्रा (it is दीर्घ)
- (C) 1 मात्रा (it becomes ह्रस्व)
- (D) 4 मात्रा (the values simply add)

36. गुण-sandhi turns अ + इ into ए (e.g. उप + इन्द्रः → उपेन्द्रः). The vowel ए is long (दीर्घ). So a short अ + short इ junction yields a vowel of:

- (A) 1 मात्रा (ए is short)
- (B) 2 मात्रा (ए is a दीर्घ vowel)
- (C) 3 मात्रा (ए is प्लुत)
- (D) 0 मात्रा (the vowels cancel)

37. वृद्धि-sandhi turns अ + ए into ऐ (e.g. एक + एकम् → एकैकम्). Since ऐ is दीर्घ, the junction produces a vowel of:

- (A) 1 मात्रा
- (B) 3 मात्रा
- (C) 2 मात्रा
- (D) 5 मात्रा

38. Before sandhi, मम + आत्मा has at the junction अ (1 मात्रा) + आ (2 मात्रा) = 3 मात्रा of vowel time. After sandhi to ममात्मा the junction is a single आ. Comparing total junction-vowel time before and after:

- (A) it drops from 3 मात्रा to 2 मात्रा — sandhi can shorten total duration
- (B) it stays 3 मात्रा — duration is always conserved

(C) it rises to 4 मात्रा

(D) it falls to 1 मात्रा

39. A reciter must lengthen the final इ of a word into ई before a pause. This change adds how many मात्रा to that vowel?

(A) 0 मात्रा (no change)

(B) 2 मात्रा (from 1 to 3)

(C) -1 मात्रा (it shortens)

(D) 1 मात्रा (from 1 to 2)

40. In the word 'सत्यम्' the first syllable is 'स' — a short अ-vowel immediately followed by the conjunct 'त्य' (त् + य). Classify this syllable for मात्रा-weight and give the correct reason.

(A) laghu (1 मात्रा) — a syllable built on short अ is always light, and a following conjunct never changes its weight

(B) guru (2 मात्राs), but only because अ is itself counted as a दीर्घ (long) vowel

(C) guru (2 मात्राs) — a short vowel becomes heavy 'by position' whenever a conjunct (samyukta) consonant follows it

(D) laghu (1 मात्रा) — only a vowel standing before anusvāra or visarga turns guru, not one before a conjunct

41. The contrast रौति / रुवन्ति teaches a rule that ALSO governs which other pair?

(A) गच्छति (goes) / अगच्छत् (went) — present vs past

(B) गच्छति (he goes) / गच्छन्ति (they go) — singular vs plural

(C) बालः (boy) / बाला (girl) — masculine vs feminine

(D) लघु (light) / गुरु (heavy) — syllable weight

42. A student writes 'कुक्कुटाः रौति' for 'the roosters crow'. The error and fix are:

(A) the verb is fine; the subject should be singular कुक्कुटः

(B) रौति is already plural, so it is correct (C) change रौति to the past tense अरौत्

(D) the plural subject कुक्कुटाः needs the plural verb रुवन्ति, not singular रौति

43. If रौति means 'crows/cries' for one bird, the most likely meaning of रुवन्ति when several birds call together is:

(A) '(they) crowed' — same as रौति but past

(B) '(they) crow / cry' — same action, plural subject

(C) '(one bird) crows loudly' — singular, intensified

(D) '(they) stop crowing' — opposite action

44. Match correctly: a crow is वायसः, a peacock is शिखी, a pigeon is कपोतः. Which extra pairing is also correct?

(A) a sparrow is नकुलः

(B) a mouse is शिखी

(C) a rooster is वायसः

(D) a sparrow is चटका

45. नकुलः and मूषकः are famous natural enemies. Identify them correctly:

(A) नकुलः = mouse, मूषकः = mongoose

(B) नकुलः = mongoose, मूषकः = mouse/rat

(C) नकुलः = crow, मूषकः = pigeon

(D) both are birds

46. पुंस्कोकिलः is built from पुम् (male) + कोकिलः (cuckoo). Its meaning is therefore:
 (A) a female cuckoo (B) a male crow
 (C) a male cuckoo (D) a pair of cuckoos
47. If भेदः means 'type' and उपभेदः means 'sub-type', then within वर्णमात्रा, the three quantities ह्रस्व, दीर्घ, प्लुत are best called the:
 (A) भेदाः (types) of vowel-quantity (B) उपभेदाः (sub-types) of consonants
 (C) verbs of crowing (D) names of birds
48. The prefix उप- in उपभेदः signals a 'sub-' or 'lesser' division. By the same prefix-logic, उपनगरम् would most likely mean:
 (A) a giant capital city (B) the destruction of a town
 (C) a town's mayor
 (D) a sub-town / suburb (a lesser settlement beside a city)
49. A teacher opens with ध्यानं निदधतु. The mood/intent is:
 (A) a polite imperative — a respectful 'please pay attention'
 (B) an angry command to leave (C) a question asking who is absent
 (D) a past-tense report of yesterday
50. ध्यानम् (attention) is the OBJECT of निदधतु ('let [one] place'). The whole phrase therefore literally asks the students to:
 (A) place a physical object on the desk (B) remove their attention and rest
 (C) count the lessons (D) place / fix their attention (i.e. attend)
51. In वर्णमात्रा the element वर्ण means a sound/letter, yet वर्ण can elsewhere mean 'caste/colour'. This single word carrying multiple senses by context is an example of:
 (A) a spelling mistake (B) a lack of vocabulary
 (C) a verb conjugation (D) polysemy
52. A reader insists वर्णमात्रा is about social caste. The decisive reason this is wrong is:
 (A) वर्ण can never mean caste in any text
 (B) the topic is मात्रा (the time-duration of sounds), so वर्ण here must mean sound/letter, not caste
 (C) मात्रा means caste, so वर्ण means colour (D) the chapter is about birds, not sounds
53. Why does Sanskrit treat vowel-length as important rather than optional?
 (A) because length is phonemic — changing a vowel's quantity can change a word's meaning, and it is essential to correct chanting
 (B) because Sanskrit has no consonants to rely on
 (C) because every word has exactly one vowel
 (D) because length only matters in writing, never in speech

54. Two words differ only in one vowel's length, e.g. a short-vowel form versus its long-vowel form. The most accurate description is:

- (A) they can be different words with different meanings, because length is phonemic
- (B) they are always the same word, since length never matters
- (C) they differ only in caste
- (D) they differ only in handwriting

55. Adding up: a word made of one ह्रस्व, one दीर्घ, and one प्लुत vowel (in any order) totals how many मात्रा, and how many syllables does it have?

- (A) 3 मात्रा across 3 syllables
- (B) 6 मात्रा across 6 syllables
- (C) 9 मात्रा across 3 syllables
- (D) 6 मात्रा across 3 syllables

56. A student claims: 'A दीर्घ vowel is 1 मात्रा, and रुवन्ति is singular.' Both halves are wrong. The fully corrected statement is:

- (A) a दीर्घ vowel is 2 मात्रा, but रुवन्ति is still singular
- (B) a दीर्घ vowel is 1 मात्रा, and रुवन्ति is plural
- (C) a दीर्घ vowel is 3 मात्रा, and रुवन्ति is singular
- (D) a दीर्घ vowel is 2 मात्रा, and रुवन्ति is plural (रौति is singular)

57. Putting the chapter together, the BEST one-line summary of वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः is:

- (A) a lesson on the social caste-system using bird names
- (B) a chapter on counting consonants in a word
- (C) an introduction to the three time-quantities of vowels (ह्रस्व 1, दीर्घ 2, प्लुत 3) with bird-call examples and supporting vocabulary
- (D) a guide to musical pitch in Sanskrit songs

58. Count the total मात्रा in देवी: vowels ए (in दे) and ई (in वी).

- (A) 3 मात्रा
- (B) 4 मात्रा (2 + 2)
- (C) 2 मात्रा
- (D) 5 मात्रा

59. In the word पुत्रः the first syllable पु carries short उ followed by the conjunct त्र. By the weight rules, पु is:

- (A) लघु (light), because उ is short
- (B) गुरु, because उ is a long vowel
- (C) लघु, because conjuncts have no effect on weight
- (D) गुरु (heavy), because the short उ is closed by the following conjunct त्र

60. A reciter pronounces the call 'आ-3' (a drawn-out आ held for three मात्रा). Comparing this to a normal आ, what has changed?

- (A) it has become a short ह्रस्व आ (1 मात्रा)
- (B) the normal आ is दीर्घ (2 मात्रा); held for 3 मात्रा it has become a प्लुत
- (C) it stays दीर्घ — duration cannot exceed 2 मात्रा
- (D) it has turned into a consonant

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 13: वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः (Varna-Matra: Vowel Quantity) — Paper 3

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	B	21	A	31	C	41	B	51	D
2	D	12	C	22	B	32	D	42	D	52	B
3	A	13	C	23	B	33	C	43	B	53	A
4	B	14	C	24	D	34	B	44	D	54	A
5	B	15	A	25	D	35	B	45	B	55	D
6	D	16	A	26	C	36	B	46	C	56	D
7	D	17	C	27	A	37	C	47	A	57	C
8	B	18	C	28	A	38	A	48	D	58	B
9	A	19	C	29	A	39	D	49	A	59	D
10	A	20	A	30	C	40	C	50	D	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (C) The मात्रा is the time-unit equal to one short vowel. A दीर्घ (long) vowel lasts as long as two short vowels, so it counts as two मात्रा. Holding it for only one मात्रा would make it short (ह्रस्व); three मात्रा would make it प्लुत (prolonged); 'half a मात्रा' is shorter than any Sanskrit vowel can be.

2. (D) वर्णमात्रा is purely about duration — how long a vowel is sounded — measured in time-units called मात्रा. Loudness (volume) and pitch (musical tone) are different acoustic properties not measured by मात्रा, and weight in grams is not a property of a sound at all.

3. (A) A मात्रा is anchored to the duration of one short vowel as that particular speaker says it. If the speaker talks faster, every मात्रा shortens together; the RATIOS (1 : 2 : 3 for ह्रस्व : दीर्घ : प्लुत) stay fixed but the absolute time is not a fixed second. It is a time-unit, not a length in centimetres, and वर्ण here is sound, not caste.

4. (B) A दीर्घ vowel equals two मात्रा, so against a drum that marks one short vowel (one मात्रा) per beat, it spans two beats. One beat would shorten it to ह्रस्व; three beats would stretch it to प्लुत; half a beat is impossible.

5. (B) मात्रा comes from the sense 'measure' (cognate with 'metre', 'mensuration'). It quantifies how much — here, how much TIME a vowel takes. It is unrelated to colour, caste, or silence.

6. (D) Sanskrit recognises THREE quantities: ह्रस्व, दीर्घ and प्लुत. The omitted one is प्लुत (3 मात्रा). There is no fourth length; अनुस्वार is a nasal sound, not a vowel-length; and pitch (accent) is a separate matter from quantity.

7. (D) Increasing order is ह्रस्व (1) < दीर्घ (2) < प्लुत (3). Sounding one of each gives 1 + 2 + 3 = 6 मात्रा. The reversed order is decreasing; '3 मात्रा' wrongly counts the three syllables as one each; '5' drops a unit.

8. (B) प्लुत = 3 मात्रा and ह्रस्व = 1 मात्रा, so the प्लुत lasts $3 \div 1 =$ three times as long. 'Twice' is the दीर्घ-to-ह्रस्व ratio; equal length and half-length contradict the definitions.

9. (A) The fixed ratios are ह्रस्व : दीर्घ : प्लुत = 1 : 2 : 3, so दीर्घ = $2 \times$ ह्रस्व and प्लुत = $3 \times$ ह्रस्व. दीर्घ does not equal ह्रस्व, प्लुत does not equal दीर्घ, and ह्रस्व (1) is the SHORTEST, not the longest.

10. (A) 1 मात्रा = ह्रस्व, 2 मात्रा = दीर्घ, 3 मात्रा = प्लुत. Reading 1, 2, 3 in order gives ह्रस्व, दीर्घ, प्लुत. The other orderings mis-pair at least one value.

11. (B) अल्पकालिक: ('little time') is ह्रस्व (1 मात्रा); अतिविलम्बकालिक: ('greatly-delayed time') is प्लुत (3 मात्रा); लम्बकालिक: ('long time') in between is दीर्घ (2). So the pair is ह्रस्व and प्लुत, and the other pairings misplace at least one label.

12. (C) आ is a long vowel — दीर्घ, 2 मात्रा. The inherent अ in म is a short vowel — ह्रस्व, 1 मात्रा. So they differ in quantity. Neither is प्लुत (that would need a 3-मात्रा drawn-out call), so the all-same and प्लुत answers are wrong.

13. (C) Within each pair the unbarred member is short: अ, इ, उ are ह्रस्व (3 of them), while their counterparts आ, ई, ऊ are दीर्घ. So exactly three are short — not two, four, or all six.

14. (C) ई is the long counterpart of इ, hence दीर्घ, worth 2 मात्रा. Its short partner इ is 1 मात्रा (ह्रस्व); a 3-मात्रा प्लुत is a specially drawn-out call; and ई is certainly a vowel.

15. (A) आ, ई, ऊ are the long (दीर्घ) counterparts. अ, इ, उ are all short (ह्रस्व); the mixed set अ, आ, इ has two short and one long; and क, ख, ग are consonants, not vowels.

16. (A) A vowel deliberately held for three मात्रा, typical of a dramatic call, is प्लुत. One मात्रा would be ह्रस्व and two दीर्घ; a consonant is not a vowel-length at all.

17. (C) गजः = ग(अ) + ज(अ) + ः. Both vowels are short अ = 1 मात्रा each, so $1 + 1 = 2$ मात्रा. (The visarga ः is not itself a vowel and adds no मात्रा here.) Counting 3 or 4 over-counts; 1 ignores a syllable.

18. (C) Both आ are long (दीर्घ) = 2 मात्रा each, so $2 + 2 = 4$ मात्रा. Treating them as short would give 2; mixing would give 3; '6' wrongly counts a प्लुत somewhere. No प्लुत is present.

19. (C) न carries short अ (1 मात्रा); दी carries long ई (2 मात्रा). Total = $1 + 2 = 3$ मात्रा. Treating ई as short gives 2; treating both as long gives 4; '1' drops a syllable.

20. (A) Both ई and आ are दीर्घ = 2 मात्रा each: $2 + 2 = 4$ मात्रा. Counting either as short gives 2 or 3; '5' over-counts. No प्लुत appears.

21. (A) क(अ) + म(अ) + ल(अ) + म् — the three short अ vowels give $1 + 1 + 1 = 3$ मात्रा. The final म् is a vowel-less consonant (halant) and carries no मात्रा of its own. Treating it as a fourth vowel gives 4; doubling gives 6; dropping a syllable gives 2.

22. (B) ई and आ are both दीर्घ = 2 मात्रा each, so $2 + 2 = 4$ मात्रा. Treating one as short gives 3; both as short gives 2; '5' over-counts.

23. (B) रवि = र(अ,1) + वि(इ,1) = 2 मात्रा. रवी = र(अ,1) + वी(ई,2) = 3 मात्रा. The only change is इ→ई, adding 1 मात्रा, so रवी is 1 मात्रा longer — not equal, not 2 longer, and certainly not shorter.

24. (D) भू normally has long ऊ = दीर्घ, 2 मात्रा. Stretching it to three मात्रा turns it into a प्लुत. So the pupil over-lengthened दीर्घ into प्लुत — the opposite of shortening, and the sound is still a vowel.

25. (D) Although अ is short, it is immediately followed by the conjunct cluster त्र्य, which makes the syllable heavy (गुरु) by 'position'. The first distractor ignores the closing conjunct; the second wrongly calls अ long; the third denies the conjunct rule that is exactly what applies.

26. (C) A syllable with a long (दीर्घ) vowel is गुरु by nature, regardless of what follows. रा is heavy because आ is long. The number of consonants is irrelevant; there is no conjunct after it; and आ is long, not short.

27. (A) A short vowel followed by अनुस्वार (ं) becomes a heavy (गुरु) syllable by position. So अं is गुरु even though अ itself is short. The first distractor ignores the अनुस्वार; the second mislabels अ as long; the अनुस्वार nasalises but does not delete the vowel.

28. (A) A short vowel followed by विसर्ग (ः) is heavy (गुरु) by position. दुः is therefore गुरु although उ is short. Ignoring the विसर्ग (first option), calling उ long (second), or dismissing विसर्ग as having no effect (fourth) all misapply the rule.

29. (A) A short vowel becomes heavy only when CLOSED by a conjunct (two-or-more consonant cluster), अनुस्वार or विसर्ग. Here अ is followed by a single म that begins the next

syllable, so क stays लघु (light). A single following consonant does not make it heavy; अ is short; and every vowel-bearing syllable is either light or heavy.

30. (C) First syllable ग has short अ but is closed by the conjunct ङ्ग, making it गुरु by position. Second syllable गा has long आ, गुरु by nature. So both are heavy. Calling either light misses one of the two heaviness causes.

31. (C) Position-heaviness arises when a short vowel is closed by a conjunct, अनुस्वार (ं) or विसर्ग (ः). Beginning with a vowel, carrying a pitch (accent), or being a noun has nothing to do with quantity/weight.

32. (D) शा contains long आ, so it is गुरु by NATURE (nature-heaviness), independent of position. Position from a following consonant is a SEPARATE cause; being first means nothing; and आ is long, not short.

33. (C) मात्रा-counting sums the time-values of the vowels (ह्रस्व 1, दीर्घ 2, प्लुत 3); a vowel-less consonant (halant) adds nothing, and letters per se are not the unit. Counting letters, counting consonants, or counting only long vowels all give the wrong total.

34. (B) When इ + इ (or इ + ई) coalesce, the result is long ई = दीर्घ = 2 मात्रा, exactly the sum 1 + 1. The time is conserved, not halved (which would lose a मात्रा) nor inflated to प्लुत (3); and after sandhi they are no longer two separate vowels.

35. (B) In सवर्ण-दीर्घ sandhi, अ (1) + आ (2) merge into ONE long आ = दीर्घ = 2 मात्रा; the merged vowel does not simply pile up to 3 or 4, nor shrink to a short 1. The result is a single दीर्घ.

36. (B) ए (and ओ) are दीर्घ (long) vowels worth 2 मात्रा. So अ + इ → ए gives a 2-मात्रा vowel. ए is never a short 1-मात्रा vowel, never प्लुत, and vowels do not cancel to zero in sandhi.

37. (C) ऐ (and औ) are दीर्घ (long) vowels = 2 मात्रा. So अ + ए → ऐ gives a single 2-मात्रा vowel, not a 1-मात्रा short, not a 3-मात्रा प्लुत, and certainly not 5.

38. (A) Two adjacent vowels अ + आ (1 + 2 = 3 मात्रा) merge into one आ (2 मात्रा), so the total junction time DROPS from 3 to 2. Duration is not always conserved in this सवर्ण-दीर्घ merge; it does not rise to 4 or collapse to 1.

39. (D) Short इ = 1 मात्रा; long ई = 2 मात्रा. Lengthening इ → ई adds exactly 1 मात्रा. It is not zero (the duration does change), not +2 (that would make प्लुत), and it lengthens rather than shortens.

40. (C) The vowel अ in 'स' is ह्रस्व (short, normally 1 मात्रा = laghu). But a laghu vowel is reckoned guru (2 मात्राs) 'by position' when a conjunct consonant follows — here त्य (त्+य) follows, so 'स' is guru. The idea that a following conjunct never matters is the very rule being tested and is wrong; अ is short, not long, so weight cannot come from vowel-length;

and the lengthening trigger is not limited to anusvāra/visarga — a following conjunct counts equally.

41. (B) रैति vs रुन्ति is a NUMBER contrast (singular vs plural), exactly like गच्छति vs गच्छन्ति. The other pairs show tense, gender, or syllable-weight — different categories, not number agreement.

42. (D) कुक्कुटाः is plural ('roosters'), so it requires the plural verb रुन्ति; रैति is singular and clashes in number. Forcing the subject to singular changes the meaning; रैति is not plural; and switching to past tense does not fix the NUMBER mismatch.

43. (B) रुन्ति keeps the SAME verbal action as रैति but marks a plural subject, so it means '(they) crow / cry'. It is not a past tense, not a singular with intensity, and not the opposite action — only the number changes.

44. (D) चटका is a sparrow. नकुलः is a mongoose (not a sparrow), शिखी is a peacock (not a mouse — that is मूषकः), and वायसः is a crow (not a rooster — that is कुक्कुटः).

45. (B) नकुलः is the mongoose and मूषकः the mouse/rat — the classic predator–prey pair. The reversed pairing swaps them; neither is a crow or pigeon; and both are mammals, not birds.

46. (C) The prefix पुम्/पुंस् marks 'male', and कोकिलः is 'cuckoo', so पुंस्कोकिलः is a male cuckoo. It is not female, not a crow, and not a pair.

47. (A) ह्रस्व, दीर्घ, प्लुत are the three main TYPES (भेदाः) of vowel quantity. They are not sub-types of consonants, not verbs, and not bird-names.

48. (D) उप- means 'near / subordinate / sub-', so just as उपभेदः is a sub-type, उपनगरम् is a sub-town (suburb). It is not a larger capital, not destruction, and not a person/office.

49. (A) ध्यानं निदधतु is a courteous imperative meaning 'please pay attention'. It is neither a harsh dismissal, nor a question, nor a past-tense statement.

50. (D) Literally 'let [you] place attention' — i.e. fix your attention, attend. It is figurative placing of ATTENTION, not a physical object; it asks for attention, not its removal; and it has nothing to do with counting.

51. (D) One word (वर्ण) bearing several context-dependent meanings (sound, colour, social class) is polysemy. It is not an error, not a poverty of vocabulary, and not a verb form.

52. (B) Because मात्रा means a time-duration of a SOUND, the वर्ण it modifies must be the phonetic sense (sound/letter). वर्ण CAN mean caste elsewhere (so 'never' is false); मात्रा does not mean caste; and the chapter's core IS sounds, with birds only as phonics examples.

53. (A) Vowel length is phonemic: e.g. a short vs long vowel can distinguish words, and accurate मात्रा is vital in recitation/chanting. Sanskrit has plenty of consonants, words have many vowels, and length matters most precisely in SPEECH, not merely writing.

54. (A) Since length is phonemic, lengthening a vowel can yield a genuinely different word with a different meaning. It is not 'always the same word', the difference is one of sound-duration (not caste), and it is a difference in pronunciation, not mere handwriting.

55. (D) मात्रा total = 1 + 2 + 3 = 6. Each vowel heads one syllable, so there are 3 syllables. '3 मात्रा' counts each as one; '6 syllables' confuses मात्रा with syllable-count; '9' wrongly multiplies.

56. (D) दीर्घ = 2 मात्रा (not 1, not 3) and रुवन्ति = plural (रौति is the singular). Only the option that fixes BOTH errors is right; each distractor keeps at least one mistake.

57. (C) The chapter introduces the three vowel quantities by TIME (ह्रस्व 1, दीर्घ 2, प्लुत 3), using the rooster's crow and other animal vocabulary as illustration. It is not about caste, not about counting consonants, and not about musical pitch (which is accent, a separate topic).

58. (B) ए is a दीर्घ vowel (2 मात्रा) and ई is दीर्घ (2 मात्रा), so 2 + 2 = 4 मात्रा. A common slip is to treat ए as a short 1-मात्रा vowel (giving 3) or both as short (giving 2); '5' over-counts. Both syllables are heavy दीर्घ vowels.

59. (D) Short उ is closed by the conjunct cluster ऋ, so the syllable पु is गुरु (heavy) by position even though उ itself is short. Ignoring the conjunct (first option), mis-labelling उ as long (second), or denying the conjunct rule (fourth) all misapply position-heaviness.

60. (B) Normal आ is दीर्घ = 2 मात्रा. Drawing it out to 3 मात्रा makes it a प्लुत, the third (prolonged) quantity used in calls and chanting. It does not shorten to 1 मात्रा, duration CAN exceed 2 (that is exactly what प्लुत is), and a vowel does not become a consonant.